UNIT 2 Media

Text 1 How TikTok broke social media?

Lesson 3 / 4

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课程资料：https://chezvivian.github.io/class/posts/2026-9-8-BusinessEnglish-2026/



¾ Roadmap



01

Text 1

How TikTok broke social media?



Barely (adv.) 几乎不

含义：

- 刚好达到最低限度；只差一点点就达不到
- Only just; almost not

例句：

- **I can barely hear you.**
  我勉强能听见你，几乎听不见。
- **He is barely 20.**
  他刚满 20 岁，不超过 20 岁。

它为什么“像否定词”？

- barely 本身形式上是肯定副词，但语义上有否定倾向，相当于 **almost not**（几乎不）。
- 因此它通常不能和 not、no、nobody 等其他否定词叠加。

词	是否关于频率	含义	例句
rarely	是	很少发生，频率低	**I rarely eat fast food.** 我很少吃快餐。
barely	否	勉强、刚刚、几乎不	**I barely finished the report.** 我勉强写完了报告。

英文	结果	中文
I almost passed.	没通过	我差一点就通过了。
I barely passed.	通过了	我勉强通过了。

Interesting words!

Wean off 使戒除

- 字面意思：断奶



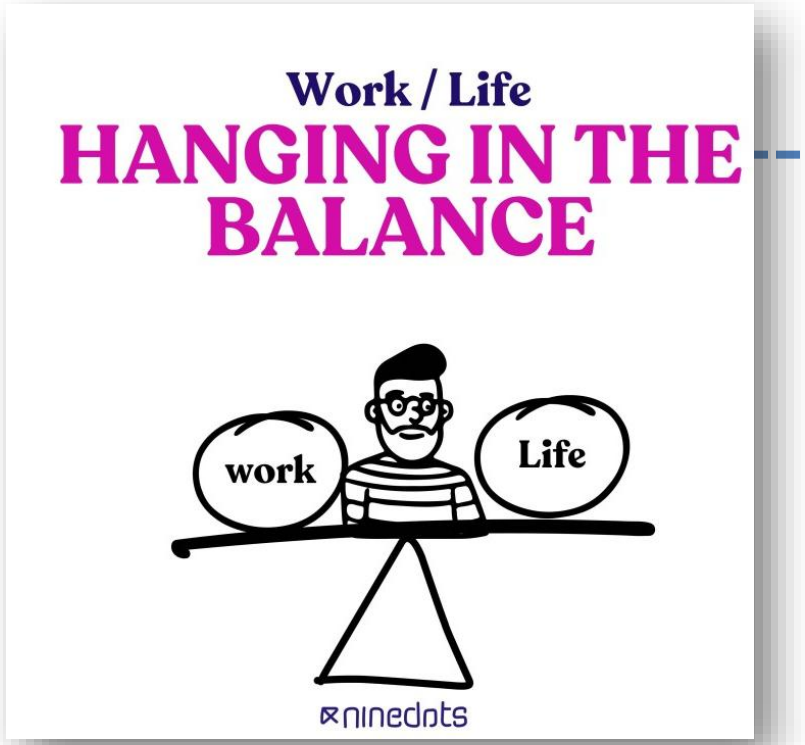
词源：

O.E. **wenian** "**to accustom,**"
from *P.Gmc.* ***wanjanan** (*cf. O.N.* **venja**, *Du.* **wennen**, *O.H.G.* **giwennan**, *Ger.* **gewöhnen** "to accustom"), from ***wanaz** "accustomed" (related to wont). The sense of **weaning a child from the breast** in *O.E.* was generally expressed by **gewenian** or **awenian**, which has a sense of "**unaccustom**" (*cf. Ger.* **abgewöhnen**, **entwöhnen** "to wean," *lit.* "to unaccustom"). The prefix subsequently wore off. Figurative extension to any pursuit or habit is from 1526.

Interesting words!

Hang in the balance 悬而未决

- 字面意思：在天平上荡来荡去



词源：

late 13*c.*, "**apparatus for weighing**," from *O.Fr.* **balance** (12*c.*) "balance, scales for weighing," also in the figurative sense; from *M.L.* **bilancia**, from *L.L.* **bilanx** (*acc.* **bilancem**), from *L.* **(libra) bilanx** "(scale) having two pans," possibly from *L.* **bis** "twice" + **lanx** "dish, plate, scale of a balance." The accounting sense is from 1580s; the meaning "general harmony between parts" is from 1732; sense of "physical equipoise" is from 1660s. The verb is attested from 1570s. **Balance of power** in the geopolitical sense is from 1701; **balanced** meal, diet, *etc.* is from 1908.

Kahoot time!



1 + 2

Text structure



Text (Para. 3)

TikTok's success has **prompted** its rivals to reinvent themselves.

Meta, which owns Facebook and Instagram, has turned both apps' main **feeds** into algorithmically sorted "discovery engines" and launched Reels, a TikTok clone **bolted** onto Facebook and Instagram.

TikTok's Chinese sister app, Douyin, is having a similar effect in its home market, where **digital giants** like Tencent are increasingly putting short videos at the center of their offerings.

Translation

TikTok 的成功**促使**它的竞争对手们彻底重塑自我。

拥有 Facebook 和 Instagram 的 Meta 公司，已经将这两款应用的主页**信息流**转变为由算法分类的“发现引擎”，并推出了 Reels，这是一个快速**附加到** Facebook 和 Instagram 上的 TikTok 克隆产品。

TikTok 的中国姐妹应用“抖音”，在本土市场也正产生着类似的影响，在中国，像腾讯这样的**数字巨头**们正越来越多地将短视频置于其产品服务的核心位置。

Text (Para. 4)

The result is that short-form video has **taken over** social media.

Of the 64 minutes that the average American spends viewing such services each day, 40 minutes are spent watching video clips, up from 28 minutes just three years ago, estimates Bernstein, a **broker**.

However, this transformation comes with a **snag**.

Although users have a seemingly endless appetite for short video, the format is proving less **profitable** than the old news feed.

Translation

结果就是，短视频已经**占据**了社交媒体的主导地位。

据**券商**伯恩斯坦 (Bernstein) 估计，美国人平均每天花费 64 分钟观看此类服务，其中有 40 分钟用于观看视频剪辑，而就在三年前，这一时长仅为 28 分钟。

然而，这场变革也伴随着一个**障碍**。

尽管用户对短视频的需求似乎无穷无尽，但事实证明，这种格式的**盈利能力**不如旧式的新闻信息流。

Kahoot time!



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3 + 4

Game time! *Monetization problems* (P5-P9)

For each individual paragraph (P5, P6, P7, P8, P9), identify the following:

- ✓ The **Key Sentence** that best summarizes the paragraph‘s main idea



Key sentences

Para 5:	**Problem**: Tiktok **monetizes** at a **lower rate** than Facebook and Instagram.
Para 6:	**Opinion**: the **gap** might **not be closed**.
Para 7:	**Reason 1**: Video's **ad load** is **lower** than text and images.
Para 8:	**Reason 2**: **Weaker targeting** also **hampers** monetization.
Para 9:	**Conclusion**: Both social apps and **advertisers** are **losers**.

Text (Para 5)

TikTok **monetizes** its American audience at a rate of just $0.31 for every hour the typical user spends on the app, **a third** the rate of Facebook and **a fifth** the rate of Instagram (see Chart 3 on the next page). The most comforting explanation for the *earnings gap* is that TikTok is **immature**. "TikTok is still a **toddler** in the social media ad landscape," says Jasmine Enberg of Insider Intelligence, who points out that the app introduced ads only in 2019. Platforms tend to keep their **ad load** low while getting new users **on board**, and **advertisers** take time to **warm to** new products.

Monetize (v.) 变现；货币化

monetize content/traffic (内容/流量变现)

- (n.) monetization 货币化

immature (adj.)不成熟的；早期的

immature market/product (不成熟的市场/产品)

- 反义词：mature, developed

Text (Para 5)

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Toddler (n.) 学步儿童；（比喻）初期事物

e.g., still in the toddler stage (仍处于初期阶段)

Ad load (n.)广告负载量；广告密度

- high/low ad load (高/低广告密度)

Get on board 加入；接受（并支持）

- get investors on board (让投资者加入)

Warm to (v.) 渐渐产生兴趣；开始喜欢

- warm to the idea/suggestion (开始喜欢某个想法)

Text (Para 5)

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TikTok在美国用户身上的变现效率仅为每小时0.31美元——相当于 Facebook的三分之一、Instagram的五分之一（见下页图表 3）。关于这一盈利差距，最主流的解释是TikTok尚不成熟。行业分析师Jasmine Enberg指出："在社交广告领域，TikTok仍处于'幼儿'阶段"，她强调该平台直到 2019 年才引入广告系统。新兴平台为吸引用户，通常刻意控制广告负载量，且广告商也需要时间适应新产品。

How to describe figures? (图表)

- ✓ Find out all the **descriptions of figures** in Paragraph 6.
- ✓ Let's try to make sentences out of them!



What do you see from the two charts on Page 35?

X-axis
横轴

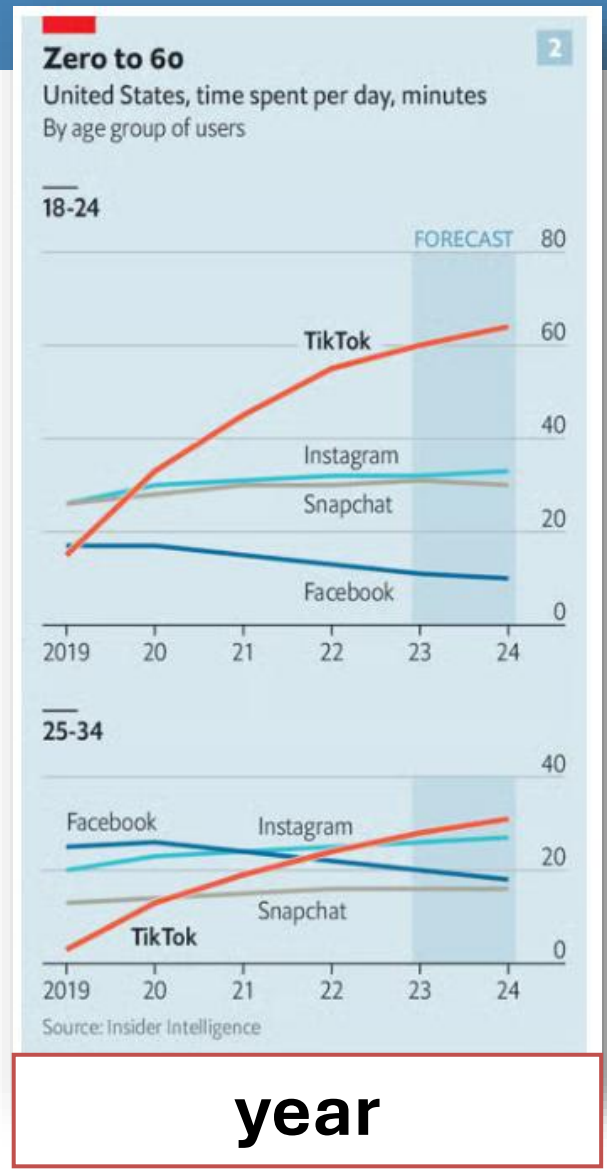
Y-axis
纵轴

Lines
折线



Users (monthly Active)

year



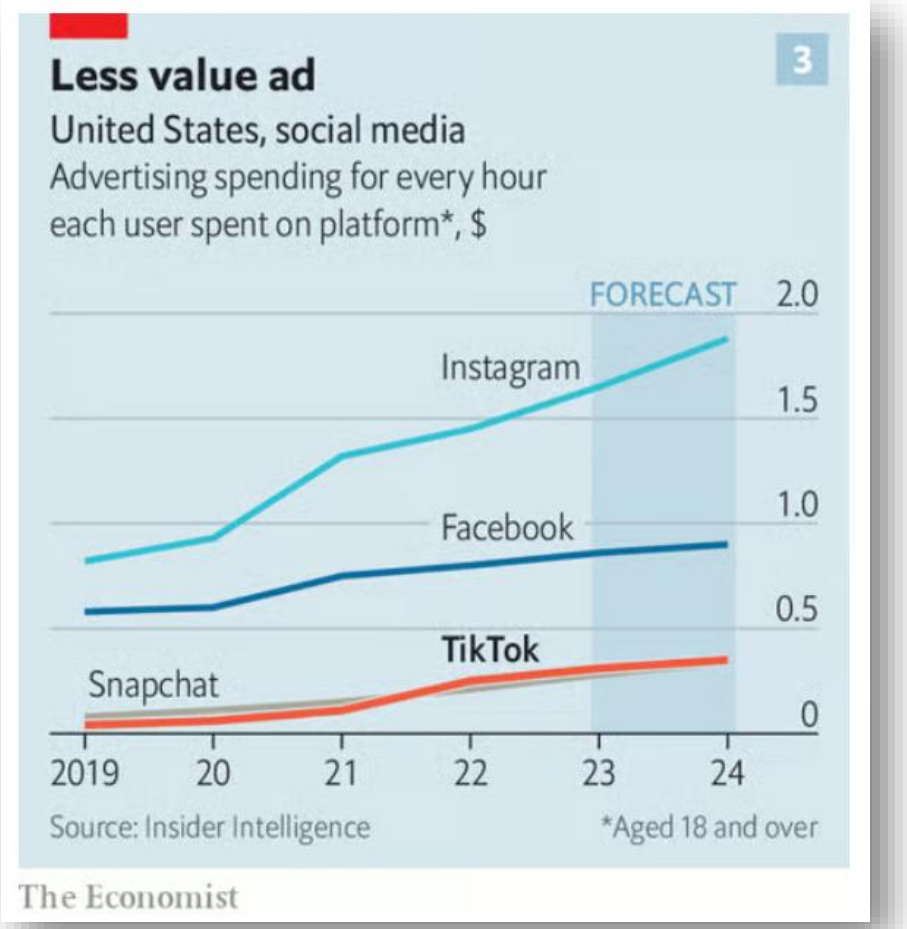
Time spent Per day

year

Comparisons and percentages

- **Make less than half as much money** per user-hour as Facebook or Instagram…
- **Monetize at only about 15% the rate of** ads…

What else can you read from the figure (图表)?

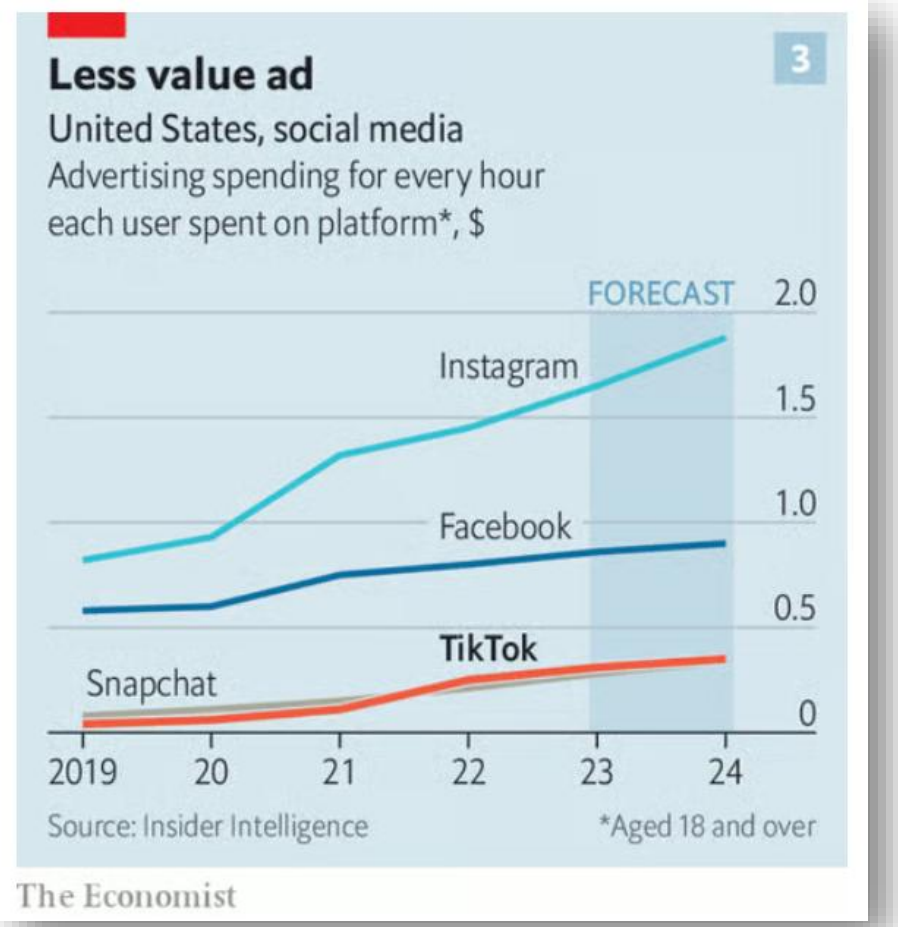


Write a sentence of a new finding from the figure.

提示：描述22-24年间，四家公司的广告收入的排名对比情况。

Key words:

- maintained its dominant position
- ranked second/occupied third position
- far below/significantly higher than



Write a sentence of a new finding from the figure.

参考写作：

Instagram maintained its dominant position, reaching nearly 2.00 per user–hour in 2024. **Facebook** ranked second at 0.80, while **Tiktok** occupied third position at $0.30–far below the top two platforms. **Snapchat** remained close to zero, with **Instagram**'s revenue significantly higher than all competitors.



Text (Para. 6)

Some wonder if the **gap** will in fact ever be **closed**. Even mature video-apps cannot **keep up with** the old social networks when it comes to monetizing their users' time. YouTube, which has been around for 18 years, makes less than half as much money per user-hour as Facebook or Instagram, estimates Bernstein. In China, where short-form video **took off** a few years before it did in the West, short-video ads in 2022 monetized at only about 15% the rate of ads on local **e-commerce** apps.

- **gap ... be closed 弥合差距**
  - 类似：bridge the gap
- **keep up with 跟上，赶上**
  ~ the tide 顺应时事
  ~ the news 关心新闻
- **take off 起飞、突然流行**
  e.g. His career took off after meeting his partner.
- **e-commerce 电子商务**

Text (Para. 6)

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但质疑在于：这一**差距**是否真能**弥合**？即便是成熟的视频平台，在用户时间变现效率上也**难以匹敌**传统社交网络。伯恩斯坦公司估计，成立 18 年的 YouTube，其单用户每小时收益仍不足 Facebook 或 Instagram 的一半。而在短视频更早**兴起**的中国市场，2022 年短视频广告的变现效率仅相当于本地**电商**类应用的 15%。

Kahoot time!



课程

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Text (Para. 7)

For one thing, the ad load in video is **inescapably** lower than on a news feed of text and images. Watch a five-minute YouTube clip and you might see three ads; **scroll** Instagram for five minutes and you could see dozens. Watching video also seems to put consumers in a more passive mood than scrolling a feed of friends' updates, making them less likely to click through to buy.

- **Inescapably (adv.) 不可避免地**

  in- (not) + escape (逃脱) + -ably (副词后缀)

  -同义词：**inevitably, unavoidably**

- **scroll (v.) 滚动浏览、刷（手机/网页）**

  scroll through (浏览)

  scroll down/up (向下/上滚动)

  e.g. Stop scrolling and go to sleep! 别刷手机了，赶紧睡觉！

Kahoot time!



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Text (Para. 7)

For one thing, the ad load in video is **inescapably** lower than on a news feed of text and images. Watch a five-minute YouTube clip and you might see three ads; **scroll** Instagram for five minutes and you could see dozens. Watching video also seems to put consumers in a more passive mood than scrolling a feed of friends' updates, making them less likely to click through to buy.

首先，视频中的广告加载量不可避免地低于文字和图片信息流。观看一个五分钟的YouTube视频片段，你可能只会看到三个广告；而刷五分钟Instagram，你可能会看到几十个广告。此外，观看视频似乎也会让消费者比浏览朋友动态时更处于一种被动状态，使他们不太可能点击广告进行购买。

Gestures

手势	英文	怎么做	典型场景
滚动	scroll	手指上下（或左右）滑，页面跟着连续移动	刷信息流、看长文
轻扫	swipe	快速横向（或纵向）一甩	左滑删除、右滑返回、滑卡片
轻点	tap	点一下	打开 App、点链接
双击	double-tap	连点两下	放大照片、点赞
长按	press and hold / long-press	按住不放	弹出菜单、多选
拖动	drag	按住再移动	整理图标、调进度条
捏合缩小	pinch (in)	两指捏拢	缩小地图/图片
张开放大	pinch out / spread	两指分开	放大照片
旋转	rotate	两指拧转	转照片
下拉刷新	pull to refresh	在顶部下拉再松手	刷新微信/微博
从边缘滑入	swipe from edge	从屏幕边缘向内滑	返回、唤出控制中心

Text (Para. 8)

Short-video apps are also **hampered** by weaker targeting. For audiences, part of the appeal of TikTok is that users need do no more than watch, and **swipe** when they get bored. The **algorithm** uses this to learn what kinds of videos—and therefore ads—they like. But this guesswork is no **substitute** for the hard personal data **harvested** by the previous generation of social networks, which persuaded users to fill in a **lengthy** profile including everything from their education to their **marital** status.

- **Hamper (v.) 阻碍、妨碍**

同义词： hinder, obstruct, impede
反义词： help, facilitate
e.g. Bad weather hampered rescue efforts. 恶劣天气阻碍了营救任务。

- **Swipe (v.) 划、滑动（屏幕）**

- swipe left/right/up/down (向左/右/上/下滑)
- swipe through (滑动浏览)

- **Substitute (n.) 替代品**

- no substitute for... (无法替代...)
- a poor substitute (差劲的替代品)
- substitute A for B / substitute A with B (用B替代A)

Text (Para. 8)

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- **Harvest (v. & n.) 收割；收集（数据**
  - Farmers harvest wheat in autumn. (原意)
  - Facebook harvests personal data from users. (引申义)
- **Lengthy (adj.) 冗长的；详细的**
  同义词： long, detailed, extensive
  反义词： brief, short, concise
- **Marital (adj.) 婚姻的；婚姻状况的**
  /ˈmærɪtl/
  - marital status (婚姻状况) ✓✓✓
  - marital problems/issues (婚姻问题)
  - marital relationship (婚姻关系)

Text (Para. 8)

Short-video apps are also **hampered** by weaker targeting. For audiences, part of the appeal of TikTok is that users need do no more than watch, and **swipe** when they get bored. The **algorithm** uses this to learn what kinds of videos—and therefore ads—they like. But this guesswork is no **substitute** for the hard personal data **harvested** by the previous generation of social networks, which persuaded users to fill in a **lengthy** profile including everything from their education to their **marital** status.

短视频应用还面临一个劣势：广告定向不够精准。TikTok吸引用户的一个原因恰恰是操作简单——只需要看视频，看腻了就滑走。算法会根据这些行为推测用户的喜好，并据此推荐视频和广告。然而，这种推测远不如传统社交网络掌握的真实用户数据可靠。Facebook等平台曾说服用户填写非常详细的个人档案，涵盖教育程度、婚姻状况等方方面面的信息。

Text (Para. 8)

The **upshot** is that many advertisers still treat short-form video as a place for loosely targeted so-called brand advertising, to raise general awareness of their product, rather than the **hyper-personalized** (and more valuable) direct response ads that **old-school** social networks **specialize** in.

- **Upshot (n.) 结果、结局、要点**
  - What's the upshot? (结论是什么？)
  - The upshot of... is... (...的结果是...)

  同义词： outcome, result, consequence, conclusion
- **hyper-personalized (adj.) 高度个性化的**
  - e.g. Hyper-personalized recommendations increase sales.
  - 其他 hyper- 词汇：hyper-competitive (竞争极其激烈的) hyper-focused (高度专注的)
- **Old-school (adj.) 老派的、旧式的、传统的**
- **Specialize in (v.) 专门从事；专攻；擅长**

  同义词： focus on, concentrate on, excel in

Text (Para. 8)

The **upshot** is that many advertisers still treat short-form video as a place for loosely targeted so-called brand advertising, to raise general awareness of their product, rather than the **hyper-personalized** (and more valuable) direct response ads that **old-school** social networks **specialize** in.

因此，许多广告商仍然只是把短视频平台当作投放品牌广告的渠道，目的是提升产品的整体知名度，而不是投放**传统**社交网络**所擅长的**那种**高度个性化**（且更有价值）的直接响应广告。

Kahoot time!



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Text (Para. 9)

Social apps will not be the only losers in this new, **trickier** ad environment. If social- media advertising becomes less effective across the board, it will be bad news not just for the **platforms** that sell those ads, but for the advertisers that buy them.

- **Tricky (adj.) 棘手的；复杂的；**

trick (诡计；技巧) - 名词
tricky (棘手的) - 形容词
同义词： difficult, complicated, challenging, problematic
使用场景：
a tricky situation/question (棘手的局面、难题)
tricky to navigate (难以驾驭)

- **Platform (n.) 平台**

技术/商业语境：
social media platforms (社交媒体平台)
e-commerce platforms (电商平台)
digital platforms (数字平台)
物理语境：
train platform (火车站台)
stage platform (舞台)
政治语境：
political platform (政治纲领)

Text (Para. 9)

Social apps will not be the only losers in this new, **trickier** ad environment. If social- media advertising becomes less effective across the board, it will be bad news not just for the **platforms** that sell those ads, but for the advertisers that buy them.

社交应用不会是这个新的、更加棘手的广告环境中唯一的输家。如果社交媒体广告整体上变得效果更差，这不仅对销售这些广告的平台来说是坏消息，对购买这些广告的广告商来说也是坏消息。

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Summary: How Tiktok Broke Social Media
TikTok 如何改变社交媒体

模式转变
(Format Shift)

- TikTok 驱动了社交媒体的巨大转型，用户从传统的**社交网络**转向了**算法推荐的短视频**模式。对手如 Meta 也被迫模仿 (Reels)，将主页转为“发现引擎”。

用户喜爱度高
(High User Engagement)

- 转变速度惊人。年轻受众尤其青睐 TikTok，美国 18-24 岁用户每天花在 TikTok 上的时间是 Instagram 和 Snapchat 的两倍。

盈利能力挑战
(Profitability Challenge)

- **新模式的盈利效率不如旧模式**，且这种差距可能长期存在。

Summary (continued)



盈利低下的结构性原因
(Structural Reasons for Low Profitability)

- **1. 货币化效率低** (Low Monetization Rate)
- **2. 广告负载限制** (Ad Load Restriction)
- **3. 用户被动性高** (High User Passivity)
- **4. 定位能力弱** (Weaker Targeting)
- **总结：更棘手的广告环境** (A Trickier Ad Environment)

Homework

- ✓ 完成 Unit 2 Language skills 1,2,3 题（Page 47)
- ✓ 预习 Unit 2 Career skills: Small talk
- ✓ 下节课（周五）由李若姗老师代课。请同学们认真听讲！

END